PRE-CLASS PREP

Nutrition

Know Before You Go

Read this before class — it will make the lecture click faster.

Big picture: Nutrition is foundational to healing, immunity, and recovery. Nurses assess nutritional status, implement prescribed diets, manage dysphagia safely, and coordinate enteral and parenteral nutrition — not just deliver trays.

BMI & NUTRITIONAL NEEDS

- **BMI = weight (kg) ÷ height² (m²)**
- Underweight <18.5 · Normal 18.5–24.9 · Overweight 25–29.9 · Obese ≥30
- BMI is a screening tool — combine with clinical assessment
- **Caloric needs:** 25–35 kcal/kg/day; more if critically ill
- **Protein needs:** 0.8–1.0 g/kg/day; more if critically ill or healing a wound

DIET TYPES

NPO
Nothing by mouth

Clear Liquid
Broth, juice, gelatin

Full Liquid
All liquids including dairy

Pureed
Smooth, no lumps

Soft
Easy to chew; limited texture

Regular
No restrictions

DYSPHAGIA & ASPIRATION

- **Signs of dysphagia:** coughing while eating, voice change after swallowing, regurgitation, abnormal tongue/mouth movements
- **Silent aspiration:** no cough — but O_2 drops or recurrent pneumonia
- Consult **speech therapy** for swallow study (IDDSI framework)
- Sit upright **90°** for all meals; maintain 30–60 min after eating
- **Never upgrade or downgrade diet without an order**; educate family — a well-meaning visitor bringing the wrong food is a real safety risk

ENTERAL & PARENTERAL NUTRITION

- **Enteral (NG tube, G-tube):** through GI tract; check placement before each feeding; HOB elevated; check gastric residuals; monitor for diarrhea, hyperglycemia, tube occlusion
- **Parenteral (TPN/PPN):** IV through central line when GI tract cannot be used; goal is to transition enteral → oral
- Enteral is always preferred over parenteral when GI tract is functional

SPECIAL DIETS & DISEASE

- **Low sodium (<2 g/day):** heart failure, hypertension, CKD, cirrhosis
- **Renal diet:** restrict K^+, phosphorus, sodium, protein, fluid
- **Diabetic:** consistent carbs 45–60 g/meal; coordinate meals with insulin
- **Cancer/chemo:** high calorie/protein; address nausea; manage mucositis
- Never force dietary compliance — educate, discuss, document refusals, notify dietitian
- Always respect cultural and religious food practices